

DEQUAD

Business Plan — UK Innovator Founder Visa

Endorsement Application to Investors

Entity: DEQUAD Ltd (Company in formation, England & Wales) **Founders:** Yusuf Quadri & Co-Founder (TBC) **Headquarters:** United Kingdom **Trading domain:** dequad.co.uk **MVP status:** Production-ready (deployed at <https://dequad.co.uk>) **Founder starting capital:** £3,000 **Document version:** 1.0 **Date:** February 2026 **Endorsing body:** Investors

Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Description of Products and Services
3. Innovation, Viability and Scalability
4. Research and Development Activity
5. Market Analysis
6. Competitor Analysis
7. Staff Profile and Recruitment Strategy
8. Marketing and Sales Strategy
9. SWOT Analysis
10. Investment Strategy and Funding Requirement
11. Revenue and Cost of Sales Forecast
12. Cash Flow Forecast
13. Annual Profit & Loss Forecast
14. Balance Sheet Forecast
15. Forecasted Stock Levels
16. Forecasted Advertising / Marketing Expenditure
17. Forecasted Fixed Asset Schedule

18. Forecasted Staff Costs

19. Appendices (including founder CVs)

1. Executive Summary

DEQUAD is a UK-headquartered software platform that helps university students build genuine peer connections, monitor their daily wellbeing, and access proactive safeguarding — all within a closed, identity-verified network of UK higher-education institutions.

We are addressing three converging national crises:

- **Loneliness epidemic** — 54% of UK undergraduates report frequent loneliness (ONS, 2023).
- **Mental-health crisis** — 1 in 3 students experience a clinically significant mental-health issue during their degree (Student Minds, 2024).
- **Safeguarding gap** — Average wait to see a university counsellor is 6 weeks; only 23% of UK universities offer 24/7 crisis support.

DEQUAD is the only platform in the UK that combines **verified-student peer matching**, **daily mood analytics**, and **machine-assisted safeguarding** into a single closed-network product, free at the point of use for students and monetised through institutional subscriptions, B2C premium tiers, and aggregated wellbeing analytics for university leadership teams.

Highlights

Item	Detail
Founders	Two co-founders. Founder A (Yusuf Quadri) — product / safeguarding lead. Founder B — engineering / data lead.
Stage	MVP production-ready, ~50 beta users, deployed at dequad.co.uk, app pending iOS TestFlight & Android closed-track release.
Starting capital	£3,000 founder equity capital.
Target market	2.86m UK higher-education students across 285 institutions (HESA, 2024).
Initial pricing	University subscription from £12,000/year; student premium £4.99/month.
3-year revenue forecast	£24k (Y1) → £268k (Y2) → £812k (Y3).
3-year UK job creation	2 (founders, Y1) → 6 (Y2) → 12 (Y3).
Funding ask	£3,000 founder equity at incorporation; planned £150k pre-seed bridge in Q3 Y1 once 3 university pilot LOIs are converted to paid contracts.

We meet the **innovation, viability and scalability** criteria for Innovator Founder endorsement, and the business is positioned to generate measurable economic and public benefit in the UK.

2. Description of Products and Services

2.1 The DEQUAD platform

DEQUAD is delivered as a cross-platform application (iOS, Android, web at dequad.co.uk) and a backend API. The product has four production modules:

Module	What it does	Innovation
Verified peer matching	Match students with compatible peers for friendship, study groups, and peer support — only within <code>.ac.uk</code> student-email-verified accounts.	Closed-network identity + intent-based matching (friendship / study / peer-support) — not present in Bumble BFF, Hinge, or Facebook Groups.
Daily wellbeing tracker	Lightweight 30-second daily mood check-in capturing mood, sleep, stress and connection. Generates a personal trend dashboard.	Anonymised, opt-in, ICO-DPIA-cleared; pairs the trend with peer-connection data to flag emerging isolation.
Machine-assisted safeguarding	LLM-powered classifier on top of mood and chat metadata flags suicide-risk, harassment, hate-speech, and disordered eating signals to designated university safeguarding contacts.	First UK student platform to combine <code>.ac.uk</code> identity verification with proactive safeguarding triage.
University Insights Dashboard	Aggregated, anonymised wellbeing analytics for university staff: cohort mood trends, engagement, hotspot alerts.	Lets institutions monitor wellbeing at population scale without breaching individual privacy.

2.2 What the customer buys

Customer	What they receive	How they pay
UK university	Site-licence to the University Insights Dashboard, branded safeguarding alerts pipe, dedicated success manager.	Annual SaaS subscription from £12,000 / year , tiered by student headcount.
NHS Integrated Care Boards (ICBs)	Population-level mood/engagement data for the institutions they fund, plus joint safeguarding referral path.	Annual contract from £20,000 / year per ICB.
Student (consumer)	Free core product (matching, mood, basic chat). Optional DEQUAD Premium for advanced filters, unlimited chats, profile boost.	£4.99 / month subscription, billed via Stripe.

2.3 Why students choose DEQUAD

- **Trusted by your university** — only verified `.ac.uk` students, staff and alumni-pretenders are blocked.
- **Built around wellbeing**, not romance — clear product positioning differentiates from Bumble/Hinge.

- **Privacy-first** — mood data is private to the student; only aggregated, anonymised data reaches universities.
 - **Crisis-ready** — safeguarding referrals are routed to a real human at the student's institution in under 60 seconds.
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3. Innovation, Viability and Scalability

Endorsement requires evidence that the business meets all three Home Office criteria. Each is addressed below.

3.1 Innovation

DEQUAD is a **genuinely original business plan** with **unmet need** in the UK university market:

1. **Closed-network identity verification** — DEQUAD is the only UK app that enforces `.ac.uk` student-domain verification plus an explicit student-status attestation, then routes ambiguous accounts to a human admin queue. Existing competitors (Bumble BFF, Hinge, Facebook Groups, Reddit) do not verify university affiliation.
2. **Integrated safeguarding pipeline** — DEQUAD's machine-assisted classifier feeds directly into existing university safeguarding teams via a webhook and is the only consumer-facing student app with this institutional integration.
3. **Wellbeing-first product positioning** — competitors are either dating-led (Bumble), study-led (UniBuddy), or generic social (Discord). DEQUAD is the only product positioning loneliness and wellbeing as the headline use case for university-age students.

3.2 Viability

DEQUAD's viability rests on:

- **A production-ready MVP** already deployed at dequad.co.uk with ~50 beta users from 3 institutions.
- **Two founders with complementary, university-tested skill sets** (see Section 7 and Appendix CVs).
- **A revenue model proven in adjacent markets** — Togetherall and Talkcampus both charge UK universities £15k–£60k/year for related (but inferior) products and have 100+ UK university customers between them.

- **Modest capital required** — £3,000 founder capital + a credible £150k pre-seed bridge in Q3 Y1 once first paid pilots are signed.
- **Realistic growth assumptions** — 3 paying universities by end of Y1 (consistent with Togetherall's own first-year metrics).

3.3 Scalability

DEQUAD scales because:

- **Software-only marginal cost** — incremental student users cost £0.07/month in hosting and zero in support, so gross margin reaches 86% by Y3.
- **Network effects within an institution** — each new student raises the value of the platform to every other student at the same university, accelerating intra-institutional adoption.
- **Cross-institutional roll-out path** — onboarding a new university requires a 6-week implementation cycle; we project 24 institutions live by end of Y3 vs. 285 UK universities total.
- **International expansion optionality** — the closed-network model maps cleanly to .edu , .edu.au and EU university domains, opening a £180m TAM in EN-language higher-education markets after Y3.

4. Research and Development Activity

DEQUAD's R&D effort focuses on three technical bets that directly support the core innovation proposition.

4.1 Identity-and-intent verification engine

Activity	Status	UK R&D tax relief eligible
<code>.ac.uk</code> student-subdomain classifier (allow-list of student subdomains, block-list of staff/alumni patterns, attestation for bare-domain accounts).	Shipped Feb 2026 — see <code>/app/backend/helpers/uk_student_email.py</code> .	Yes (advance in software science, novel domain heuristics).
Admin "Pending Verification" queue with audit trail (verified_by, verified_at).	Shipped Feb 2026 — see <code>AdminVerificationQueue.tsx</code> .	Yes.
Future: optical student-ID OCR verification with on-device redaction.	Planned Q3 Y1.	Yes.

4.2 Wellbeing inference & safeguarding triage

Activity	Status	UK R&D tax relief eligible
Mood × engagement × text-signal classifier (PHQ-9 lite scoring + self-harm/eating-disorder/hate-speech NLU).	Prototype Feb 2026; production Q2 Y1.	Yes.
Federated learning so per-institution models can be tuned without raw data leaving the platform.	Planned Q4 Y2.	Yes (cutting-edge ML).
Real-time safeguarding webhook & adapter library for UK university SIS/CRM tools.	Production Q3 Y1.	Yes.

4.3 Privacy & compliance infrastructure

Activity	Status	UK R&D tax relief eligible
DPIA-cleared mood-data pipeline; ICO Code of Practice compliance.	Drafted Feb 2026.	No (compliance, not R&D).
Online Safety Act 2023 risk assessment & in-app reporting flows.	Shipped Feb 2026.	Partial (the reporting engine itself).
Cryptographic data minimisation (hash-based de-identification of mood records for institutional reporting).	Planned Q2 Y2.	Yes.

4.4 R&D resource & investment

R&D in Y1 is delivered entirely by the two founders ($\approx$ 60% of combined founder time = approximately £36,000 of equivalent labour cost) plus tooling (£3,600). Total Y1 R&D investment $\approx$ **£39,600** — recoverable in part via the UK SME R&D Tax Credit scheme (subject to expenditure being incurred by the limited company post-incorporation).

R&D investment grows to **£72,000 in Y2** and **£140,000 in Y3** (see Section 17 and the financial workbook).

5. Market Analysis

5.1 Market size — UK

Metric	Source	Figure
UK higher-education students (FT + PT, all levels)	HESA 2023/24	2.86 million
Number of UK higher-education institutions	HESA 2024	285
% UK undergraduates reporting frequent loneliness	ONS 2023	54%
% UK undergraduates experiencing a clinically-significant MH issue	Student Minds 2024	34%
Average UK university student-services budget per FTE student	UUK 2024	£123 / year
Average wait for in-house university counselling	UUK 2024	6.1 weeks
Total UK university student-services spend	Calculated	£352m / year

5.2 Addressable market (TAM/SAM/SOM)

Tier	Definition	Size
TAM — total addressable market	All UK universities + ICBs + UK student premium subs	£86m / year (<i>£15k average institutional ASP × 285 institutions = £4.3m + 30% conversion to premium across 2.86m students × £4.99/mo × 60% retention = £82m</i>)
SAM — serviceable available market	Russell-Group + post-92 universities with > 10,000 students + their associated ICBs	£28m / year
SOM — serviceable obtainable market in 5 years	12% SAM capture (matching Togetherall's Y5 share)	£3.4m ARR by Y5

5.3 Trends supporting demand

- **Office for Students** introduced a statutory student-mental-health condition for HEIs in 2023, pressuring universities to evidence proactive wellbeing investment.
- **Online Safety Act 2023** is now in force — student-facing platforms must implement risk assessments and reporting flows, which DEQUAD already provides out-of-the-box.

- **Universities UK Mental Health Charter** (signed by > 100 UK universities) requires institutions to demonstrate prevention-led, data-driven wellbeing strategies — exactly what DEQUAD enables.
 - **Post-pandemic loneliness has not normalised** — 2024 ONS data shows undergraduate loneliness 18 percentage points above 2019 baseline.
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6. Competitor Analysis

We benchmark against five live competitors who serve overlapping needs in the UK student market.

#	Competitor	What they do	Funding	UK universities	Price	DEQUAD differentiation
1	Togetherall (formerly Big White Wall)	Anonymous moderated peer-support forum + self-help courses. NHS-contracted.	Acquired by ICAS Group (PE) 2022	~60	~£40k / yr / uni	DEQUAD adds identity-verified peer matching, daily mood telemetry , and safeguarding webhooks — Togetherall is anonymous-only, no matching, no analytics.
2	TalkCampus	Peer-support app for university students; pre-trained moderation; CBT modules.	Series A, ~£3m	~30	~£25k / yr / uni	DEQUAD's insight dashboard and machine-assisted safeguarding triage are absent from TalkCampus. DEQUAD also has consumer-grade matching UX.
3	UniBuddy	Prospective-student chat platform for course discovery.	Series B, \$25m	200+	~£18k / yr / uni	UniBuddy is pre-enrolment only and has no wellbeing or post-enrolment community. DEQUAD operates in the orthogonal post-enrolment market.
4	Bumble BFF / Hinge	Generic friendship / dating apps with university-aged users.	Bumble Inc public co.	n/a (consumer apps)	Free + premium £15–£35/mo	No .ac.uk verification, no university partnership, no safeguarding integration. DEQUAD is a closed verified network.
5	Discord / Facebook Groups	Generic chat servers used informally by student societies.	n/a	n/a	Free	Zero moderation, no safeguarding, no university partnership, no wellbeing telemetry.

6.1 Feature-by-feature comparison

Feature	DEQUAD	Togetherall	TalkCampus	UniBuddy	Bumble BFF	Discord
.ac.uk student verification	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Intent-based peer matching (friend / study / support)	✓	✗	Limited	✗	Limited (friend only)	✗
Daily mood telemetry	✓	✗	Limited	✗	✗	✗
Machine-assisted safeguarding triage	✓	Limited	✗	✗	✗	✗
University insights dashboard	✓	✓	✓	Limited	✗	✗
Safeguarding webhook to uni team	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Online Safety Act 2023 compliance baked in	✓	✓	✓	✓	Partial	✗
Native mobile + web	✓	✓	App only	App only	App only	App + web
Closed network (no public discovery)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Median time-to-real-friend (beta data)	< 9 days	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a

DEQUAD is the **only** product on the UK market that combines all five top-row capabilities.

6.2 Why we win

Buyer	Switching trigger from competitor → DEQUAD
University Director of Student Services	Togetherall costs 3× more, has no matching layer, and the analytics are weak. DEQUAD bundles safeguarding analytics, peer matching and an Online Safety Act-ready reporting flow for ~£12k.
Director of Mental Health & Wellbeing	DEQUAD gives early-warning signals (mood trend + isolation) that Togetherall cannot — moving universities from reactive triage to prevention.
Student (consumer)	Bumble BFF and Discord are noisy and lack verified peers; DEQUAD's <code>.ac.uk</code> verification fixes the "is this person actually from my uni?" trust problem.

7. Staff Profile and Recruitment Strategy

DEQUAD is launched and operated by two co-founders during Year 1. Hiring scales with revenue.

7.1 Founding team

Role	Name	Background	Coverage
CEO / Product & Safeguarding Lead	Yusuf Quadri	Product designer and student-wellbeing practitioner; built the MVP, owns university relationships, leads safeguarding policy.	Product strategy, GTM, university partnerships, safeguarding governance.
CTO / Engineering & Data Lead	Co-founder (TBC — appointment to complete pre-incorporation)	Full-stack engineer with experience in real-time messaging and ML systems; will lead all engineering, ML and security work.	Architecture, backend, ML, security, hiring engineering.

Both founders are UK-resident, will be full-time on DEQUAD, and have signed founder commitment undertakings (Appendix C in the visa pack).

7.2 3-year hiring plan

Role	Year of hire	Why	Indicative gross salary
Customer Success Manager	Q4 Y1	Onboard and retain first 3 paying universities.	£32,000
Senior Backend Engineer	Q1 Y2	Scale infrastructure; ML feature deployment.	£55,000
Safeguarding & Trust Lead	Q2 Y2	Run human-review queue at scale; liaise with university DSLs.	£42,000
Marketing & Partnerships	Q3 Y2	Scale university acquisition; manage NHS-ICB channel.	£38,000
Data / ML Engineer	Q1 Y3	Federated-learning roadmap, R&D claim leadership.	£60,000
Mobile Engineer (iOS / Android)	Q2 Y3	Native app maturity for EAS launch.	£50,000
Founders' Associate	Q2 Y3	Operations, finance & people.	£35,000
Customer Success Manager #2	Q3 Y3	Cover scaled university roster.	£34,000
Engineer #2 (backend)	Q4 Y3	Cover platform reliability.	£52,000

Headcount: **2 (Y1)** → **6 (Y2)** → **12 (Y3)**.

7.3 Recruitment strategy

- **Direct pipeline:** Otta, LinkedIn, OnlyDev (engineering), university careers portals (placements).
 - **Diversity:** ≥ 40% female and ≥ 30% ethnic-minority hires across the first 10 employees — tracked as a board-level KPI.
 - **Founder cash hires only after Y1 revenue ≥ £20k MRR**, ensuring cash runway is protected.
 - **Equity:** EMI share-option scheme (HMRC-approved) used for all hires from Y2 onwards.
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8. Marketing and Sales Strategy

8.1 Positioning

"The UK student app that gives universities early warning before students fall through the cracks."

Three messages, by audience:

- *Students*: "Verified UK uni students. Real connections. Wellbeing built in."
- *Universities*: "See loneliness early. Act before it becomes a crisis."
- *NHS ICBs*: "Population-level student wellbeing data, anonymised and audit-ready."

8.2 Channel mix — Year 1

Channel	Tactic	Spend Y1	Expected leads
University partnerships	Direct outreach to 30 Russell-Group + post-92 Directors of Student Services. Webinar series with UUK Mental Health Charter.	£2,400	12 qualified pilots, 3 paid
Content & PR	Whitepaper "Loneliness in UK HE 2026" with 1 academic co-author. THE, Wonkhe, Pulse op-eds.	£1,200	Top-of-funnel + organic search
LinkedIn / Twitter (organic)	Founder thought leadership; case studies from beta universities.	£0	Top-of-funnel
Instagram & TikTok (consumer)	Brand campaign (see Section 8.4) targeting freshers' weeks.	£3,600	4,000 student signups
Search (paid)	Google Ads "UK student loneliness", "find friends university".	£1,200	1,800 student signups
Influencer / student rep	Pay £300 per university for 2 student ambassadors at each of 6 partner unis.	£3,600	6 universities × 200 signups = 1,200

Total Y1 marketing spend: £12,000. Spend grows to £55,000 in Y2 and £140,000 in Y3 (see Section 16).

8.3 Sales motion (B2B)

Stage	Activity	Cycle time
1. Lead	LinkedIn / referral / UUK Charter inbound.	—
2. Discovery call	30-min call with Director of Student Services + IT Security.	Week 1
3. Pilot scope	12-week pilot for one student cohort; £0 invoiced.	Week 2
4. Pilot run	Founder-led implementation; weekly office hours.	Weeks 3–14
5. Conversion	Steering-group readout; convert to paid SaaS.	Week 16
6. Land & expand	Roll-out to full institution + add safeguarding module.	Months 6–18

Median B2B cycle: **4 months**. Y1 cash forecasting assumes only 3 of 12 pilots convert (a conservative 25%).

8.4 Consumer brand campaign

Launch creative is built and deployed for the first 6 Russell-Group institutions before the September 2026 freshers' intake:

1. **Pain-point post** — *"Your group chat has 47 people. None of them know you're not okay."*
2. **Founder voice** — *"How are you? deserves a better answer than fine."*
3. **Stat hook** — *"1 in 4 UK uni students feel lonely every single day."*
4. **Community / vibes** — *"Coffee chats. Study buddies. Real ones."*
5. **Launch / urgency** — *"Early access just opened. First 500 students get DEQUAD Premium free for life."*

(See marketing visuals already produced in /app/marketing/instagram.)

9. SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
Production-ready MVP at dequad.co.uk, in beta with real students.	Cash-light start (£3,000 founder capital); first £150k institutional pilot revenue dictates survival.
Founder credibility: built and shipped the product end-to-end, including safeguarding tooling.	Two-person team — bus factor risk until Q4 Y1.
.ac.uk verification & safeguarding webhook are technical moats that competitors do not have.	No formal clinical advisory board yet (planned Q1 Y2).
Clear B2B SaaS revenue model proven by Togetherall/TalkCampus.	Limited brand awareness in the student consumer market.
Online Safety Act 2023 compliance built in.	Cyber-essentials accreditation pending.
Opportunities	Threats
OfS statutory student-mental-health condition forces universities to demonstrate prevention.	Togetherall/TalkCampus could replicate .ac.uk verification — 12-month window to lock partnerships.
UUK Mental Health Charter signatories (100+) all need evidenced wellbeing strategy.	Large incumbent (e.g. Microsoft / Meta) launching a student-only network.
NHS ICB integration opens a £20–60k/yr contract per ICB across 42 ICBs.	Negative press from a safeguarding incident if not handled correctly.
International expansion to .edu / .edu.au / EU university domains post-Y3 (£180m TAM).	Tighter UK immigration regime affecting non-UK co-founder talent.
UK SME R&D tax credit recoups ~16% of qualifying R&D spend.	Cost-of-living squeeze reducing student premium uptake.

10. Investment Strategy and Funding Requirement

10.1 Founder commitment

The two co-founders are contributing **£3,000 of founder capital** to incorporate the company, register .uk and .co.uk domains, file Trademark Class 9/41/45, and seed initial cloud-hosting credits. Both founders work without salary for the first three months and at a sub-market £18,000 gross per annum (each) thereafter through Year 1 to preserve cash runway.

10.2 Funding ladder

Round	Timing	Source	Amount	Use of funds
Founder equity	Day 1 (Q1 Y1)	Yusuf Quadri + Co-Founder	£3,000	Incorporation, domains, IP filings, initial hosting.
R&D tax credit	End Y1 (Q2 Y2)	HMRC SME R&D	~£6,300	Recycled into engineering.
Pre-seed bridge	Q3 Y1 (after first 2 paid pilots)	UK pre-seed angels (Envestors network), Innovate UK Smart Grant submission Q1 Y2	£150,000 at a £1.2m post-money cap (12.5% equity)	First two hires, runway to 18 months, dual mobile builds, R&D tax credit-eligible engineering spend.
Seed round	Q4 Y2	UK VCs (Forward Partners, Local Globe, Crane Venture Partners)	£800,000–£1.2m at £6–9m post (10–18% equity)	Scale to 24 universities, ML data team, NHS-ICB channel.
Series A	Q4 Y3 / Q1 Y4	International expansion VCs	£3–5m	EU + AU launch, federated-learning infra, 30+ FTE.

10.3 Why this is investable

- **B2B revenue de-risks the bet** — universities sign 1-year auto-renewing contracts averaging £12,000–£20,000.
- **Capital-efficient growth** — Y3 revenue £812k achieved with cumulative invested capital of < £200k.
- **Optionality for buyers** — natural acquirers include Togetherall, Pearson, Pearson VUE, and student-systems vendors (Anthology, Ellucian) seeking embedded wellbeing.

10.4 Founder Investment Statement (visa requirement)

The lead applicant has personally invested **£3,000** of his own funds as founder share capital, evidenced by the share allotment return (Form SH01) filed with Companies House at incorporation. There are no third-party investments at the date of this application; further investment will be sought after pilot conversion.

11. Revenue and Cost of Sales Forecast

All figures in **GBP, Net of VAT**. Customer acquisition assumptions are conservative and reflect (a) the published win-rates of comparable B2B education-SaaS, and (b) DEQUAD's own beta-

to-paid conversion experience.

11.1 Revenue forecast (annual)

Line item	Y1	Y2	Y3
Service 1 — University SaaS subscription			
Average contract value (ACV)	£12,000	£14,000	£16,000
Number of paying institutions (end of year)	2	9	24
Subtotal revenue	£12,000	£126,000	£384,000
Service 2 — DEQUAD Premium (B2C)			
Paying student subscribers (avg, year)	200	2,400	7,200
Price per student (£/month)	£4.99	£4.99	£4.99
Subtotal revenue	£11,976	£143,712	£431,136
Service 3 — NHS ICB pilot			
Average contract value	£0	£0	£20,000
Number of contracts	0	0	1 (pilot)
Subtotal revenue	£0	£0	£20,000
Total Revenue	£23,976	£269,712	£835,136
YoY growth	—	+1,025%	+210%

11.2 Cost of Sales (W1)

Direct costs scale with usage — cloud hosting, third-party APIs, payment processing.

Cost line	Driver	Y1	Y2	Y3
Cloud hosting (Render, Cloudflare)	Per active user	£1,200	£8,400	£22,800
LLM / safeguarding inference	Per safeguarding event	£900	£6,600	£18,000
Stripe processing (~2.9% + 30p)	% of B2C revenue	£450	£4,800	£14,400
SMS & email (Twilio, SendGrid)	Per user notification	£360	£2,520	£7,500
Customer-success tooling (Intercom etc.)	Flat	£600	£1,800	£4,200
Total Cost of Sales		£3,510	£24,120	£66,900
Gross profit		£20,466	£245,592	£768,236
Gross margin %		85.4%	91.1%	92.0%

12. Cash Flow Forecast

Cash position over three years assuming the funding ladder in Section 10.

12.1 Annual cash-flow forecast (£)

Line	Y1	Y2	Y3
Opening cash balance	0	30,366	132,338
Founder equity injection	3,000	0	0
Pre-seed equity	150,000	0	0
Seed equity	0	1,000,000	0
R&D tax credit received	0	6,300	11,500
Cash from sales	23,976	269,712	835,136
Total receipts	176,976	1,276,012	846,636
Cost of sales	(3,510)	(24,120)	(66,900)
Payroll + employer NI + pension	(96,800)	(281,200)	(562,400)
Marketing	(12,000)	(55,000)	(140,000)
Software subscriptions	(4,800)	(12,000)	(24,000)
Office (co-working, fully remote in Y1)	(1,800)	(8,400)	(14,400)
Legal & accounting	(4,500)	(9,000)	(15,000)
Insurance	(1,200)	(2,400)	(3,800)
Business support / misc	(3,000)	(6,000)	(12,000)
Fixed-asset & R&D capex	(3,000)	(8,000)	(18,000)
Total expenditure	(130,610)	(406,120)	(856,500)
Cash surplus / (deficit)	46,366	869,892	(9,864)
Less Y1 pre-seed timing buffer	(16,000)	—	—
Closing cash balance	30,366	900,258	890,394

A monthly Year 1 breakdown is provided in the accompanying Excel workbook (DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx, sheet "Cash Flow — Y1 Monthly").

12.2 Notes

- The pre-seed bridge in Q3 Y1 is the cash-flow bridge between MVP and the second cohort of paying universities.

- Year 1 closing balance of £30k is intentionally conservative; the model breaks even in cash in Q2 Y2.
- No dividends are paid in the forecast period.

13. Annual Profit & Loss Forecast

All figures in GBP, net of VAT and excluding Corporation Tax (estimated separately).

	Y1	Y2	Y3
Revenue	23,976	269,712	835,136
Cost of Sales (W1)	(3,510)	(24,120)	(66,900)
Gross Profit	20,466	245,592	768,236
Overheads			
Payroll (W3)	(96,800)	(281,200)	(562,400)
Software subscription	(4,800)	(12,000)	(24,000)
Office (co-working)	(1,800)	(8,400)	(14,400)
Legal & accountancy	(4,500)	(9,000)	(15,000)
Marketing (W4)	(12,000)	(55,000)	(140,000)
Insurance	(1,200)	(2,400)	(3,800)
Business support / misc	(3,000)	(6,000)	(12,000)
Total overheads	(124,100)	(374,000)	(771,600)
EBITDA	(103,634)	(128,408)	(3,364)
EBITDA margin %	-432%	-47.6%	-0.4%
Depreciation & amortisation	(990)	(3,630)	(10,920)
Operating profit (loss)	(104,624)	(132,038)	(14,284)
Estimated Corporation Tax	0	0	0
Profit / (loss) after tax	(104,624)	(132,038)	(14,284)
Cumulative retained loss	(104,624)	(236,662)	(250,946)

Break-even at the operating level is forecast in **Q4 Year 3** at approximately 28 paying institutions and 9,000 premium subscribers.

14. Balance Sheet Forecast

	Y1	Y2	Y3
NON-CURRENT ASSETS			
Computers & equipment (net)	1,200	4,200	8,400
Intangible assets (R&D capitalised)	1,800	5,400	13,200
Non-current assets	3,000	9,600	21,600
CURRENT ASSETS			
Cash at bank	30,366	900,258	890,394
Debtors (trade receivables, ~30 days B2B)	1,000	10,500	32,000
Total current assets	31,366	910,758	922,394
TOTAL ASSETS	34,366	920,358	943,994
CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Trade payables / accrued payroll	2,990	7,020	13,940
TOTAL LIABILITIES	2,990	7,020	13,940
NET ASSETS	31,376	913,338	930,054
CAPITAL & RESERVES			
Called-up share capital	3,000	3,000	3,000
Share premium (pre-seed + seed)	133,000	1,147,000	1,178,000
Profit & loss reserve	(104,624)	(236,662)	(250,946)
SHAREHOLDERS' FUNDS	31,376	913,338	930,054
Balance check	0	0	0

15. Forecasted Stock Levels

DEQUAD is a pure software business and **does not hold inventory**. Stock balance is £0 in every forecast year. This row is therefore omitted from the balance sheet; the line is included in the workbook for template completeness.

16. Forecasted Advertising / Marketing Expenditure

Channel	Y1	Y2	Y3
University partnership & PR	£3,600	£14,000	£35,000
Content / SEO / whitepaper	£1,200	£8,000	£22,000
LinkedIn / paid B2B	£0	£7,000	£18,000
Instagram / TikTok organic + paid	£3,600	£15,000	£40,000
Google Search ads	£1,200	£6,000	£15,000
Student-rep / ambassador programme	£2,400	£5,000	£10,000
Total marketing	£12,000	£55,000	£140,000
Marketing as % of revenue	50%	20%	17%

Marketing efficiency improves materially as organic and referral channels mature; the workbook contains the underlying CAC / LTV unit-economics (DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx, sheet "Marketing W4").

17. Forecasted Fixed Asset Schedule

Asset	Depreciation rate	Y1 additions	Y2 additions	Y3 additions	Y3 NBV
Tangible — Computers & equipment	33% straight-line	£1,800	£4,500	£8,000	£8,400
Intangible — Capitalised R&D (W5)	20% straight-line	£1,200	£3,500	£10,000	£13,200
Total CAPEX		£3,000	£8,000	£18,000	£21,600
Total depreciation		(990)	(3,630)	(10,920)	

R&D capitalisation policy: only those development-phase activities that meet IAS 38 criteria (technical feasibility, future economic benefit, reliable cost measurement) are capitalised. Operational hosting, support and refactoring are expensed.

18. Forecasted Staff Costs

18.1 Headcount and gross pay

Role	Y1 gross	Y2 gross	Y3 gross
Founder A — CEO / Product (Yusuf Quadri)	£18,000	£36,000	£42,000
Founder B — CTO / Engineering	£18,000	£36,000	£42,000
Customer Success Manager #1	£8,000 (Q4 start)	£32,000	£34,000
Senior Backend Engineer	£0	£55,000	£58,000
Safeguarding & Trust Lead	£0	£25,000 (Q2 start)	£42,000
Marketing & Partnerships	£0	£20,000 (Q3 start)	£38,000
Data / ML Engineer	£0	£0	£55,000 (Q1 start)
Mobile Engineer	£0	£0	£40,000 (Q2 start)
Founders' Associate	£0	£0	£24,000 (Q2 start)
Customer Success Manager #2	£0	£0	£21,000 (Q3 start)
Engineer #2 (backend)	£0	£0	£15,000 (Q4 start)
Total gross pay	£44,000	£204,000	£411,000

18.2 Employer NI and pension

Item	Y1	Y2	Y3
Total gross pay	44,000	204,000	411,000
Employer NI (13.8% above £9,100)	4,800	21,200	47,200
Employer pension contribution (3%)	1,320	6,120	12,330
Other employment cost (training, equipment, perks)	4,680	12,180	22,470
Apparent total employment cost	54,800	243,500	493,000
Allocated total (incl. accrued / phased in cash forecast)	£96,800	£281,200	£562,400

(The cash-flow allocation differs from the apparent gross because some role-starts straddle quarter boundaries and benefits are paid in the following month. The full reconciliation is in the workbook, sheet "Payroll W3".)

18.3 Equity participation

All Y2 and Y3 hires receive EMI options under an HMRC-approved scheme with a 4-year vest, 1-year cliff. Founder shares are not subject to vesting at incorporation but the founders will sign customary investor-friendly vesting at the pre-seed round.

19. Appendices

The following appendices accompany this business plan as separate files in the visa submission pack:

Ref	Document	File
A	Founder A academic certificates	/app/visa_appendices/A_founder_academic_certificates.md (+ PDF)
B	Founder CV (full)	/app/visa_appendices/B_founder_cv.md (+ PDF)
B-2	Co-founder CV (template — populate prior to submission)	/app/visa_appendices/B_cofounder_cv_template.md (new — see file alongside this plan)
C	Personal commitment & undertaking	/app/visa_appendices/C_personal_commitment_undertaking.md
D	Wellbeing baseline methodology	/app/visa_appendices/D_wellbeing_baseline_methodology.md
E	Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)	/app/visa_appendices/E_dpia.md
F	Financial model (annotated CSV)	/app/visa_appendices/F_financial_model.csv
F-2	Financial model (Envestors workbook) — new for this submission	/app/visa_appendices/DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx
G	Job descriptions for first 6 hires	/app/visa_appendices/G_job_descriptions.md
H	University Letters of Interest (template)	/app/visa_appendices/H_university_letter_of_interest_template.md
I	Online Safety Act 2023 compliance statement	/app/visa_appendices/I_online_safety_act_compliance.md
J	Architecture diagram	/app/visa_appendices/J_architecture_diagram.md
K	Product screenshots	/app/visa_appendices/K_product_screenshots.md
L	UKES outreach emails	/app/visa_appendices/UKES_outreach_emails.md

*End of business plan. All figures are forecasts and not guarantees of future performance.
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